

More Than Technology

What Does an Educational Technologist Really Do?

STUDENT

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PROGRAM

M.Ed. Educational Technology

COURSE

EDTC 6320

INSTITUTION

The University of Texas Rio Grande Valley



The technology is visible. The design behind the learning often is not.

01 - PROJECT DESCRIPTION

A professional introduction to the field

I developed *More Than Technology* to address a gap in how prospective students and potential employers understand Educational Technology. The project combines a public website with a 4:33 narrated multimedia presentation that explains the profession, professional responsibilities, career settings, related earnings information, historical development, learning theory, and AECT standards.

The design is grounded in audience analysis, multimedia-learning principles, Universal Design for Learning, accessibility, and authentic professional examples. The project began as a Google Sites version and was later redesigned and deployed through Vercel to provide greater control over the final instructional experience.

Primary audiences: prospective Educational Technology students and potential employers of Educational Technology professionals.

02 - RESPONSIBILITIES MET

EDTC 6320 AECT performance indicators

The indicator labels follow the AECT 2012 standards matrix used by the UTRGV Educational Technology program. The evidence statements explain how this project addresses each indicator.

STANDARD 1 - CONTENT KNOWLEDGE

1.2 Using

Evidence: I selected a public website and short multimedia format because both match the needs of busy adult viewers and support clear access to complex information. The final site uses concise sections, visual hierarchy, responsive layouts, and accessible navigation rather than adding technology that does not serve the learning goal.

1.5 Ethics

Evidence: I treated accuracy, accessibility, copyright, attribution, and honest representation of the project as design responsibilities. I avoided unsupported claims, distinguished related salary occupations from a guaranteed Educational Technologist salary, and documented AI-generated media in the media credits.

STANDARD 2 - CONTENT PEDAGOGY

2.5 Ethics

Evidence: The project represents Educational Technology across education, business, healthcare, government, nonprofit, and military settings rather than presenting one professional context as the default. The site also accounts for differences in prior knowledge, language background, ability, and technology experience.

STANDARD 3 - LEARNING ENVIRONMENTS

3.1 Creating

Evidence: I created an instructional product based on learner analysis and research-informed design. Mayer's multimedia principles shaped the final presentation through concise narration, relevant visuals, signaling, coherence, and segmentation. CAST's UDL framework informed multiple forms of representation, accessibility, and reduced barriers.

3.5 Ethics

Evidence: The final site uses semantic structure, readable typography, sufficient contrast, keyboard-accessible navigation, and responsive layouts. The multimedia presentation includes readable captions and a separate caption file. Media selection reflects copyright, Fair Use, attribution, and appropriate open access.

STANDARD 4 - PROFESSIONAL KNOWLEDGE AND SKILLS

Independent-project context: This assignment was originally structured for collaborative work, but I completed the project independently after I was unable to join a group. I therefore do not claim peer or subject-matter-expert collaboration that did not occur.

4.1 Collaborative Practice

Evidence and limitation: The collaboration component was not demonstrated in the usual team-based form. I independently completed learner analysis, instructional planning, research, content development, website development, accessibility review, and evaluation planning that would normally be distributed across a project team. Course requirements, professional standards, and scholarly sources served as professional inputs, but they are not presented as substitutes for peer collaboration.

4.5 Ethics

Evidence: I designed for two stakeholder groups and considered cultural context, learner variability, accessibility, and respectful representation. Ethical practice is also visible in the decision to separate verified evidence from assumptions and to avoid fabricating interviews, evaluation data, team participation, or outcomes.

STANDARD 5 - RESEARCH

5.1 Theoretical Foundations

Evidence: The project connects the historical development of Educational Technology with behaviorism, cognitivism, constructivism, multimedia learning, Universal Design for Learning, and professional standards. These foundations are tied directly to decisions such as segmenting content, reducing unnecessary information, using authentic examples, and providing multiple ways to access information.

Why I moved the project from Google Sites to Vercel

The first working version was created in Google Sites. Google Sites was useful for developing the initial structure quickly because it provided straightforward page creation, built-in navigation, and simple publishing. As the project developed, however, the instructional design needed more control over how information was organized and presented to the two target audiences.

I moved the revised version to Vercel so I could build a custom static website with HTML and CSS and make the design choices match the instructional goals more closely. The change was not made because Google Sites was unusable. It was a deliberate redesign decision based on the needs of the project.

Stronger information architecture.

The Google version used many separate top-level pages. The Vercel redesign consolidated related proposal content so audience analysis, learning opportunity, goals, solution, and rationale read as one connected instructional-design argument.

Greater visual control.

Vercel allowed custom spacing, typography, cards, banners, section hierarchy, and consistent visual emphasis rather than relying primarily on a standard template.

Better responsive and accessibility control.

The custom site made it possible to directly manage semantic structure, keyboard-accessible navigation, contrast, mobile layouts, descriptive links, video caption presentation, and PDF viewing.

Improved multimedia integration.

The final site could more deliberately integrate the narrated video, caption file, AI-generated educational media, downloadable Artifact Report PDF, and media credits without making the page feel crowded.

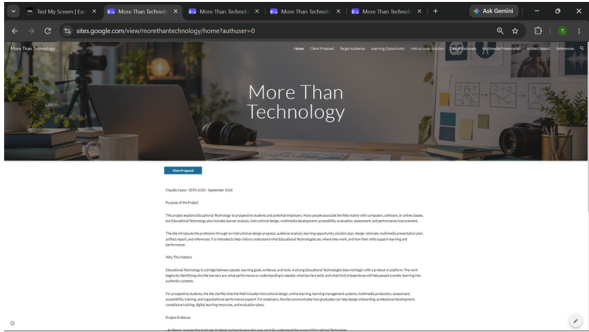
Version 1 - Google Sites:	https://sites.google.com/view/morethantechnology/home
Version 2 - Vercel:	https://educationaltechnologyutrg.vercel.app/

Design result: Moving platforms allowed the final product to become more audience-centered, visually coherent, accessible, and easier to scan while preserving the same instructional purpose and research foundation.

Home page: Google Sites to Vercel

Before & After — Home Page

VERSION 1 — GOOGLE SITES



VERSION 2 — VERCEL



WHY THIS REVISION MATTERED

The Google Sites version established the project and basic navigation, but the page remained text-heavy and used a large repeated hero image. The Vercel redesign uses a stronger visual hierarchy, clear audience pathways, custom content blocks, and more direct calls to action so prospective students and employers can understand the project purpose more quickly.

Change documented: The first version established the topic and navigation but relied on a large repeated hero image and long text blocks. The Vercel version introduced clearer audience pathways, custom content blocks, stronger calls to action, and a more deliberate hierarchy.

Client Proposal: from summary page to design argument

Before & After — Client Proposal

VERSION 1 — GOOGLE SITES

VERSION 2 — VERCEL

WHY THIS REVISION MATTERED

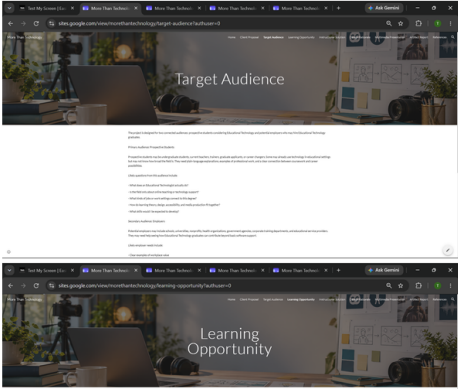
The Google Sites proposal separated information into mostly text-based pages and an executive-summary format. The Vercel version consolidates the instructional-design reasoning into a more scannable proposal, using cards, audience sections, visual hierarchy, and clearer connections among the target audience, learning gap, goals, solution, and rationale.

Change documented: The Google version presented a conventional text-based executive summary and placed other required elements on separate pages. The Vercel redesign made the instructional-design reasoning easier to follow by visually connecting project overview, audiences, learner characteristics, instructional gap, goals, solution, rationale, accessibility, and evaluation.

Audience and learning opportunity: separate pages to integrated proposal

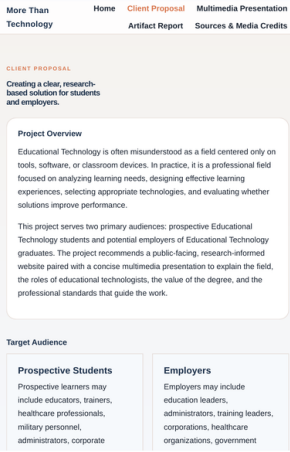
Before & After — Audience & Learning Opportunity

VERSION 1 — GOOGLE SITES



Two separate pages in Google Sites. The top page is titled 'Target Audience' and the bottom page is titled 'Learning Opportunity'. Both pages have a header image of a desk with a laptop and a plant. The content is organized into sections with bullet points.

VERSION 2 — VERCEL



A single page in Vercel titled 'Client Proposal'. The page has a navigation bar with links: 'More Than Technology', 'Home', 'Client Proposal', 'Artifact Report', 'Multimedia Presentation', and 'Sources & Media Credits'. The main content area is titled 'CLIENT PROPOSAL' and includes a 'Project Overview' section with text about Educational Technology. Below this, there are two columns: 'Target Audience' and 'Employers', each with a list of roles.

WHY THIS REVISION MATTERED

In Google Sites, Target Audience and Learning Opportunity were separate navigation pages. In Vercel, those elements are integrated within the Client Proposal so the learner characteristics, current reality, desired state, instructional gap, goals, and design decisions can be read as one connected instructional-design argument.

Change documented: Version 1 required the viewer to move among separate Target Audience and Learning Opportunity pages. Version 2 integrates those elements inside the Client Proposal so learner diversity, current reality, desired state, goals, and design decisions are easier to connect.

How the project can continue to grow

The Google-to-Vercel redesign documents meaningful development during this project. For future e-Portfolio revisions, I will preserve both public versions and use the Vercel implementation as the new baseline for continued improvement.

1 Usability and audience feedback

Gather feedback from prospective students or employers and use it to identify places where navigation, wording, or emphasis can be improved.

2 Accessibility review

Continue checking captions, keyboard navigation, contrast, mobile behavior, document access, and other barriers across devices and browsers.

3 Content currency

Refresh career, salary, standards, and emerging-technology information when authoritative sources change so the project remains accurate over time.

Evidence strategy: Future revisions will preserve screenshots and links to the earlier versions so later changes can be compared rather than replacing the development history.

What this project changed in my understanding

This project reinforced that Educational Technology begins with people and problems, not tools. The strongest design decisions came from identifying what the audience needed to understand and then choosing a structure, media approach, and level of detail that supported that need. The move from Google Sites to Vercel made that lesson practical: the platform itself became a design decision because the final implementation needed to support the audience, not simply host the content.

I also developed a stronger appreciation for the connection between theory and practical design. Multimedia principles, UDL, accessibility, ethics, and professional standards become meaningful when they change the way information is organized, represented, and evaluated. A polished product is not enough if its claims are vague, unsupported, difficult to navigate, or inaccessible. As I continue through the M.Ed. Educational Technology program, I want to strengthen my ability to connect research to practice and evaluate instructional decisions more systematically.